

ficial purposes. Indeed, this was probably the common place for worship, the females occupying, according to Jewish tradition, only a raised gallery along three sides of the court. This court covered a space upwards of 200 feet square. All around ran a simple colonnade, and within it, against the wall, the thirteen chests, or "trumpets," for charitable contributions were placed.¹ These thirteen chests were narrow at the mouth and wide at the bottom, shaped like trumpets, whence their name. Their specific objects were carefully marked on them. Nine were for the receipt of what was legally due by worshippers; the other four for strictly voluntary gifts. Trumpets I. and II. were appropriated to the half-shekel Temple-tribute of the current and of the past year. Into Trumpet III. those women who had to bring turtledoves for a burnt and a sin-offering dropped their equivalent in money, which was daily taken out and a corresponding number of turtledoves offered. This not only saved the labour of so many separate sacrifices, but spared the modesty of those who might not wish to have the occasion or the circumstances of their offering to be publicly known. Into this trumpet Mary the mother of Jesus must have dropped the value of her offering² when the aged Simeon took the infant Saviour "in his arms and blessed God." Trumpet IV. similarly received the value of the offerings of young pigeons. In Trumpet V. contributions for the wood used in the Temple; in Trumpet VI. for the incense, and in Trumpet VII. for the golden vessels for the ministry were deposited. If a man had put aside a certain sum for a sin-offering, and any money was left over after its purchase, it was cast into Trumpet VIII. Simi-

¹ It was probably into one of these that the poor widow dropped her "two mites" (Luke xxi. 2).

² Luke ii. 22, 24.